

Nick Kunz

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Research Interests

My research interests are at the intersection of machine learning, synthetic data generation, spatio-temporal modeling, and realtime information. Many of the question I ask are motivated by understanding the emergence of complex system dynamics within the context of evolving real-world constraints. My work has direct applications in housing, transportation, recreation, public health and safety, among other fields of lived experience.

Education

Cornell University — Ithaca, NY Ph.D., Systems Engineering, Artificial Intelligence <i>Advisors: H. Oliver Gao, Francesca Parise, Wenfei Xu</i>	2027
Cornell University — Ithaca, NY M.S., Systems Engineering <i>Advisors: H. Oliver Gao</i>	2025
Columbia University — New York, NY M.S., Urban Planning, Urban Analytics <i>Advisors: Lance Freeman, Kazuki Sakamoto</i>	2019
Harvard University — Cambridge, MA Urban Planning <i>Advisor: Nick Hornig</i>	2012
Arizona State University — Tempe, AZ B.S. (Hons.), <i>summa cum laude</i> , Housing and Urban Development <i>Advisors: Kevin Kellogg, Michael Underhill, Trevor Barger</i>	2012

Publications

Journal Articles

- N. Kunz, H. O. Gao, “A General Capacity Frontier of Complex Networks”. *Preprint arXiv:2610.09574*. 2026. [\[Link\]](#)
- N. Kunz, H. O. Gao, “Global Geolocated Realtime Data of Interfleet Urban Transit Bus Idling”. *Preprint arXiv:2403.03489*. 2026. [\[Link\]](#)
- D. Lu, L. Cui, N. Kunz, et. al., “Urban Infrastructure and Spatiotemporal Environmental Features for EGFR-Mutant Lung Cancer”. *Preprint medRxiv:18.26353481v1*. 2026. [\[Link\]](#)
- C. Avci, C. Huang, N. Kunz, H. O. Gao, “uTECH-Population: Synthetic Population Generation with Housing Assignment”. *Under Review*. 2026.

Conference Proceedings

- W. Wu, N. Kunz, P. Branco, “ImbalancedLearningRegression” in *Machine Learning and Knowledge Discovery in Databases: European Conference, ECML PKDD, September 19–23, 2022, Grenoble, France*, Proceedings, Part VI, Lecture Notes in Computer Science, vol 13718. Springer, pp. 645–648, 2023. [\[Link\]](#)

Working Papers

- N. Kunz, H. O. Gao, “Global Behavioral Patterns of Interfleet Urban Transit Bus Idling”. *In Preparation*. 2026.
- N. Kunz, H. O. Gao, “Network Constrained Spatial Prediction: Transfer Learning Geolocations”. *In Preparation*. 2026.

Theses

N. Kunz, “Structural Systems Intelligence: Network-Constrained Estimation of Global Transit Dynamics,” Ph.D. Dissertation, Duffield College of Engineering, Cornell Univ., Ithaca, NY, 2027.

N. Kunz, “Unsupervised Learning for Submarket Modeling: A Proxy for Neighborhood Change,” M.S. Thesis, Grad. Sch. of Arch., Plan., and Pres. (GSAPP), Columbia Univ., New York, NY, 2019. [Online]. Available: Columbia Academic Commons. [\[Link\]](#)

N. Kunz, “Realizing Interactive Architecture: A Driver of the Knowledge Economy,” B.S. (Hons.) Thesis, Barrett, The Hons. Col., Arizona State Univ., Tempe, AZ, 2012. Available: Barrett, The Honors College Thesis/Creative Project Collection. [\[Link\]](#)

Industry Reports

N. Kunz, “ n -Dimensional Mapping by Normalized Value Approximation: Squad Immersive Virtual Trainer (SiVT) Safety Performance Metrics,” Integrated Visual Augmentation System (IVAS), Microsoft, Redmond, WA, 2021. Protected from public disclosure pursuant to: Trade Secrets Act 18 USC § 1905, 5 USC § 552(b)(4), and C3.2.1.4. of US Dept. of Defense Regulation 5400.7-R. DISTRIBUTION F.

N. Kunz, “Normalized n -Dimensional Inverse Euclidean Distance: Combining Independent Performance Metrics,” Integrated Visual Augmentation System (IVAS), Microsoft, Redmond, WA, 2021. Protected from public disclosure pursuant to: Trade Secrets Act 18 USC § 1905, 5 USC § 552(b)(4), and C3.2.1.4. of US Dept. of Defense Regulation 5400.7-R. DISTRIBUTION F.

N. Kunz, “Minimum-Weighted Mean Variability: Within Group Performance Metrics,” Integrated Visual Augmentation System (IVAS), Microsoft, Redmond, WA, 2020. Protected from public disclosure pursuant to: Trade Secrets Act 18 USC § 1905, 5 USC § 552(b)(4), and C3.2.1.4. of US Dept. of Defense Regulation 5400.7-R. DISTRIBUTION F.

N. Kunz, “An Exploratory Data Analysis of the Gavin Cup: Bringing Readiness & Performance Metrics Into Focus,” Integrated Visual Augmentation System (IVAS), Microsoft, Redmond, WA, 2020. Protected from public disclosure pursuant to: Trade Secrets Act 18 USC § 1905, 5 USC § 552(b)(4), and C3.2.1.4. of US Dept. of Defense Regulation 5400.7-R. DISTRIBUTION F.

Software Packages

GRD-TRT-BUF-4I: Ground Truth Buffer for Idling

2023 - 2027

 [Github](#) [[Link](#)]  [arXiv](#) [[Link](#)]  [Website](#) [[Link](#)]

A novel algorithm designed as a series of scalable microservices that detects urban transit bus idling in realtime on global scale. Utilizes a combination of templated ETL pipelines to provide a comprehensive view of the emergent behavior of interfleet idling patterns across multiple transit networks around the world.

SMOBN: Synthetic Minority Over-Sampling Technique for Regression with Gaussian Noise

2021

 [Github](#) [[Link](#)]  [PyPI](#) [[Link](#)]  [Kaggle](#) [[Link](#)]  [Stack Exchange](#) [[Link](#)]

A pre-processing algorithm designed to address imbalanced data for regression problems. Conducts over-sampling with traditional interpolation, as well as with the introduction of Gaussian noise. Selects between the two over-sampling techniques by the KNN distances underlying a given observation.

NestedHyperBoost: Nested Cross-Validation for Bayesian Optimized Gradient Boosting

2020

 [Github](#) [[Link](#)]  [PyPI](#) [[Link](#)]

Unifies Nested K-Fold Cross-Validation, Bayesian Hyperparameter Optimization, and Gradient Boosting. Designed for rapid prototyping on small to mid-sized data sets. Quickly obtains high quality prediction results by abstracting away tedious hyperparameter tuning and implementation details in favor of usability and implementation speed.

NestedHyperLine: Nested Cross-Validation for Bayesian Optimized Linear Regularization

2020

 [Github](#) [[Link](#)]  [PyPI](#) [[Link](#)]

Unifies Nested K-Fold Cross-Validation, Bayesian Hyperparameter Optimization, and Linear Regularization. Designed for rapid prototyping on small to mid-sized data sets. Quickly obtains high quality prediction results by abstracting away tedious hyperparameter tuning and implementation details in favor of usability and implementation speed.

 Github [[Link](#)]  CRAN [[Link](#)]

A novel matrix sampling algorithm designed to conditionally random sample sparse matrices. Useful for training and test set splitting prior to model fitting in cross-validation procedures and for estimating the predictive accuracy of imputation methods, such as NNMF and SVD.

Selected Projects

N. Kunz, S. Huang, S. Osakata, “Cloudy Night: Activating Park Space by Illuminated Interactivity,” Grad. Sch. of Arch., Plan., and Pres. (GSAPP), Columbia Univ., New York, NY, 2019. [Online]. Available:

 GSAPP [[Link](#)]  Github [[Link](#)]  YouTube [[Link](#)]  Faculty [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz and S. Bhele, “Signal or Noise? Qualified Opportunity Zone Affect on Development Activity in Queens,” Grad. Sch. of Arch., Plan., and Pres. (GSAPP), Columbia Univ., New York, NY, 2019. [Online]. Available:

 GSAPP [[Link](#)]  Github [[Link](#)]  Issuu [[Link](#)]

E. Hudgins and N. Kunz, “Planning for Extreme Settlements, McMurdo Station, Antarctica,” Grad. Sch. of Arch., Plan., and Pres. (GSAPP), Columbia Univ., New York, NY, 2018. [Online]. Available:

 GSAPP [[Link](#)]  Issuu [[Link](#)]

J. Karasik, S. Lee, N. Kunz, *et. al.* “Negotiating Fragments (Restructuring Quarto Workshop),” Genoa, Italy, Grad. Sch. of Arch., Plan., and Pres. (GSAPP), Columbia Univ., New York, NY, 2018. [Online]. Available:

 GSAPP [[Link](#)]  YouTube [[Link](#)]  Issuu [[Link](#)]  Issuu [[Link](#)]  Press [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz, “Proportionalities: A Decade of Housing Markets to Subway Stations in Manhattan from 2006 to 2016,” Grad. Sch. of Arch., Plan., and Pres. (GSAPP), Columbia Univ., New York, NY, 2017. [Online]. Available:

 GSAPP [[Link](#)]  GSAPP [[Link](#)]  Issuu [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz, “Reimaged: John Snow’s Cholera Map of 1854,” Grad. Sch. of Arch., Plan., and Pres. (GSAPP), Columbia Univ., New York, NY, 2017. [Online]. Available:

 Issuu [[Link](#)]

G. S. Coch, S. Nelsen, N. Kunz, K. Warner, “Seeking Refuge: The Geography of Migrant Deaths Along the US-MX Border,” Grad. Sch. of Arch., Plan., and Pres. (GSAPP), Columbia Univ., New York, NY, 2017. [Online]. Available:

 GSAPP [[Link](#)]  Medium [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz, “Health & Wellness Alliance for Children: Children’s Asthma, Healthy Physical Environments,” Dallas County, Texas, bcWORKSHOP, Dallas, TX, 2014. [Online]. Available:

 Issuu [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz, “The Bexar Street Corridor: A Century in Development,” Dallas, Texas, bcWORKSHOP, Dallas, TX, 2013. [Online]. Available:

 Issuu [[Link](#)]  Issuu [[Link](#)]  bc [[Link](#)]  Vimeo [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz, “Fenway-Kenmore Square: Comprehensive Planning & Finance,” Cambridge, Massachusetts, Grad. Sch. of Design (GSD), Harvard Univ., Cambridge, MA, 2012. [Online]. Available:

 Issuu [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz, “Design Representation: Analog Modeling & Hand Drafting,” Grad. Sch. of Design (GSD), Harvard Univ., Cambridge, MA, 2012. [Online]. Available:

 Issuu [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz, “Danelle Plaza: Complete Street Mobility Planning,” Tempe, Arizona, Herberger Inst. for Des. and the Art., Arizona State Univ., Tempe, AZ, 2012. [Online]. Available:

📖 Issuu [[Link](#)]

N. Kunz, “Ascension: Multifamily Mixed-Use Real Estate Development Proposal,” Tempe, Arizona, Independent Project, Phoenix, AZ, 2012. [Online]. Available:

📖 Issuu [[Link](#)] N. Kunz, “Sui Residence: Second Story Architectural Design,” Paradise Valley, Arizona, Independent Project, Phoenix, AZ, 2011. [Online]. Available:

📖 Issuu [[Link](#)]

Professional Experience

Deloitte — Seattle, WA Senior Data Scientist <i>Artificial Intelligence</i> [Link]	2021 - 2025
Microsoft — Redmond, WA Data Scientist <i>Integrated Visual Augmentation System</i> [Link]	2020 - 2021
Pacific Prospecting Group — Seattle, WA Data Scientist <i>Cryptocurrency Mining & Management</i> [Link]	2017 - 2019
Brawner & Company — Snoqualmie, WA Development Analyst <i>Real Estate Development</i> [Link]	2016 - 2017
bcWORKSHOP — Dallas, TX Fellow <i>Architecture & Planning</i> [Link]	2013 - 2014

Mentorship Activities

Audrey Shin , B.S., Computer Science, Columbia University — New York, NY Machine Learning Engineer Intern, ORO Labs <i>Professional development and management in early career engineering.</i>	2025 - 2026
Albert Rosario-Pichardo , M.S., Urban Planning, Columbia University — New York, NY GIS Analyst Intern, New York City Economic Development Corporation <i>Academic and professional development in early career public service.</i>	2023 - 2024
Albert Ruiz Martinez , B.S., Computer Science, Arizona State University — Tempe, AZ Analyst, Deloitte Consulting <i>Professional development and management in early career consulting.</i>	2023 - 2024
Julia VanPutte , B.S., Operations Research, Cornell University — Ithaca, NY Business Intelligence Engineer Intern, Amazon <i>Academic and professional development from undergraduate school to industry.</i>	2022 - 2024
Chawner Hurd , M.B.A., Business, Columbia University — New York, NY Associate Intern, Visa <i>Military transition from US Army, 5th Special Forces Group to graduate school and industry.</i>	2020 - 2023
Michael Bollinger , B.A., Computer Science, Columbia University — New York, NY Software Engineer Intern, Amazon <i>Military transition from US Army, 75th Ranger Regiment to undergraduate school and industry.</i>	2019 - 2023
Daniel Hineline , B.A., Political Science, Columbia University — New York, NY Associate Intern, Guggenheim Partners <i>Military transition from US Army, 82nd Airborne Division to undergraduate school and industry.</i>	2018 - 2023

Funding & Support

Fellowships & Scholarships

Graduate Engineering Fellowship (\$42,773), Cornell University — Ithaca, NY	2023
Systems Engineering Fellowship (\$31,033), Cornell University — Ithaca, NY	2022
Korean Ancestry Grant (\$8,000), William Orr Dingwall Foundation — Washington, DC	2010 - 2012
Barrett, The Honors College Scholarship (\$4,000), Arizona State University — Tempe, AZ	2010 - 2012
AIERF Undergraduate Scholarship (\$1,000), Appraisal Institute — Chicago, IL	2010 - 2011
Study.net Foundation Scholarship (\$500), Study.net — Fort Lauderdale, FL	2010
Herberger Institute for Design & the Arts Scholarship (\$300), Arizona State University — Tempe, AZ	2010
Center for Global Education Services Scholarship (\$750), Arizona State University — Tempe, AZ	2009

Education Benefits & National Service Awards

Chapter 33: Post-9/11 GI Bill, US Dept. of Veterans Affairs — Washington, DC	2022 - 2026
Chapter 31: Veteran Readiness and Employment, US Dept. of Veterans Affairs — Washington, DC	2017 - 2019
Eli Segal AmeriCorps Education Award, US AmeriCorps — Washington, DC	2014

Honors & Awards

Applause Award, Deloitte Consulting — Seattle, WA [Link]	2022
Distinguished Alumni Award, Arizona State University — Tempe, AZ [Link]	2016

Talks & Presentations

Applications in Data Science, Cornell Data Science Club, Cornell University — Ithaca, NY	2026
Ground Truth Buffer for Idling, 3-Minutes of Madness, Cornell University — Ithaca, NY	2024
Global Geolocated Realtime Data, Flash Talks, Cornell University — Ithaca, NY	2023
Emerging Technology Workshop, Countryside Angels Talks, Ag Ventures Alliance — Mason City, IA	2021
Planning Paths in Private Tech, Alumni Panel, Columbia GSAPP — New York, NY [Link]	2021
Cloudy Night, End of Year Show, Columbia GSAPP — New York, NY [Link]	2019
Restructuring Quarto Workshop, Municipality of Genoa — Genoa, IT [Link]	2018
The Bexar Street Corridor, US Congresswoman Eddie Bernice Johnson's Office — Dallas, TX	2014
The Bexar Street Corridor, TR Hoover Community Development Corporation — Dallas, TX	2014
The Bexar Street Corridor, bcSHOPFRONT Series, bcWORKSHOP — Dallas, TX [Link]	2013
Realizing Interactive Architecture, Honors Symposium, Arizona State University — Tempe, AZ	2012

Media & Press

Urban Planning Semester In Review: Alumni Updates, Columbia GSAPP — New York, NY [Link]	2023
Spotlights: Nick Kunz, Cornell Systems Engineering — Ithaca, NY [Link]	2023
Meet the N-K Alumni Nick Kunz, Northwood Anchor, Vol. 126, No. 41, Pg. 4 — Northwood, IA [Link]	2022
Restructuring Fourth Workshop, Municipality of Genoa Press — Genoa, IT [Link]	2018
Achievement Oriented: Nick Kunz, ASU Magazine, Vol. 20, No. 2, Pg. 7 — Tempe, AZ	2016
Welcome Nick Kunz, bcWORKSHOP — Dallas, TX	2013

Academic Service

Tuesday Talks Mentorship, Columbia GSAPP — New York, NY [Link]	2026
Alumni Mentorship Program, Columbia GSAPP — New York, NY [Link]	2023 - 2024

Military Service

Assignments

US Army, 2nd Ranger Battalion, 75th Ranger Regiment — Fort Lewis, WA <i>Infantry</i>	2015 - 2016
US Army, Ranger Training Detachment — Fort Benning, GA <i>Ranger Assessment and Selection Program</i>	2015

US Army, 1st Special Warfare Training Group — Fort Bragg, NC <i>Special Forces Assessment and Selection</i>	2014
US Army, 1st Special Warfare Training Group — Fort Bragg, NC <i>Special Forces Preparation and Conditioning</i>	2014
US Army, 507th Parachute Infantry Regiment — Fort Benning, GA <i>Airborne School</i>	2014
US Army, 19th Infantry Regiment — Fort Benning, GA <i>Infantry School</i>	2014

Decorations

Expert Badge, Rifle Component Bar , US Army, 75th Ranger Regiment — Fort Lewis, WA	2016
Global War on Terrorism Service Medal , US Army, 75th Ranger Regiment — Fort Lewis, WA	2016
Driver Badge, Wheeled Vehicle Component Bar , US Army, 75th Ranger Regiment — Fort Lewis, WA	2015
Parachutist Badge, Unit Trimming , US Army, 507th Parachute Infantry Regiment — Fort Benning, GA	2014
Infantry Blue Chord Fourragère , US Army, 19th Infantry Regiment — Fort Benning, GA	2014
National Defense Service Medal , US Army, 19th Infantry Regiment — Fort Benning, GA	2014
Army Service Ribbon , US Army, 19th Infantry Regiment — Fort Benning, GA	2014

Civil Service

AmeriCorps — Dallas, TX <i>Volunteer in Service to America (VISTA)</i>	2013 - 2014
Open Architecture Collaborative — Dallas, TX <i>Architecture & Planning</i>	2013 - 2014
Trinity Park Conservancy — Dallas, TX <i>Public Park Conservation</i>	2013 - 2014

Professional Memberships

Sigma Xi — Research Triangle Park, NC	2026 - Present
The New York Academy of Sciences — New York, NY	2024 - Present
AmeriCorps Alums of North Texas — Dallas, TX	2014 - Present
Barrett, The Honors College Alumni Association — Tempe, AZ	2012 - Present
US Military Veterans of Columbia University — New York, NY	2017 - 2018
Architecture for Humanity, Dallas/Fort Worth Chapter — Dallas, TX	2013 - 2014
Social Economic Environmental Design Network — Princeton, NJ	2013 - 2014
Urban Land Institute Arizona — Phoenix, AZ	2011 - 2012
United States Green Building Council, Central AZ Chapter — Phoenix, AZ	2009 - 2012
American Institute of Architecture Students — Washington, DC	2009 - 2010

Technical Skills

Languages

Scripting: Python, Bash
Statistical: R, Stata
Compiled: C/C++, Fortran
Database: SQL, NoSQL, Cypher
Typesetting: L^AT_EX, Markdown

Frameworks

Data Science: NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, statsmodels, Featuretools, Tidyverse
Visualization: Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly, Processing, Shiny, ggplot
Statistical Learning: Scikit-Learn, XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost
Reinforcement Learning: OpenAI Baselines, Stable Baselines
AI Engineering: Pinecone, Langchain, LangGraph
Deep Learning: Pytorch, TensorFlow, ONNX

Deployment

DevOps: Git, Ubuntu, Docker, CI/CD

Databases: PostgreSQL, SQLite, CosmosDB, Neo4j

Web Services: Flask, Gunicorn, Nginx

Web Automation: Selenium, Puppeteer

Cloud Platforms: Azure, AWS, Databricks

Security: STIGs, NIST, ZAP

Software

Development Environments: VS Code, RStudio, Jupyter

Geographic Information Systems: ArcGIS, QGIS, OSM, Leaflet, Mapbox

3D Modeling & Optimization: Rhino, Grasshopper, SketchUp, AutoCAD, Unity

Design & Illustration: Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign

Financial Modeling: Excel, Macros, CoStar

Prototyping

Project Management: Agile, Scrum, Critical Path

Sensors & Hardware: Arduino, Raspberry Pi

Electrical: Soldering, Wiring, Safety

Analogs: Drawing, Hand Drafting, Physical Modeling

Personal Activities

Music & Live Audio

Atlas North American Tour — US & Canada

2013

The Word Alive (*Fearless Records*), Co-Tour Manager

The Word Alive (*Fearless Records*), Guitar Tech

Fight the Silence Tour — US

2013

The Word Alive (*Fearless Records*), Guitar Tech

For Today (*Razor & Tie Records*), Guitar Tech

All Stars Tour — US

2012

The Word Alive (*Fearless Records*), Guitar Tech

A Skylit Drive (*Fearless Records*), Guitar Tech

Van's Warped Tour — US & Canada

2011

The Word Alive (*Fearless Records*), Co-Tour Manager

Of Mice & Men (*Rise Records*), Guitar Tech

Regional Performances — US

2011

The Rendering (*Authentik Artists*), Guitar